

Five directions for a new MOtiVE 4 Artists identity.

This packet is for choosing a visual territory, not approving final production artwork. Each direction is intentionally different and drawn as an editable vector.

What the identity needs to do.

AUDIENCE AND PROMISE

Movement-based artists come first. Funders, donors, partners, and applicants must also see a credible nonprofit that builds time, space, relationships, and opportunity around what each artist actually needs.

PERSONALITY

Warm, kinetic, human, grounded, and unconventional. More rehearsal room than gala. More relationship than institution. Confident without looking corporate or precious.

REQUIRED PERFORMANCE

Website header, 16-32px favicon, social avatar, grant deck, one-color print, inexpensive signage, tote, and embroidery. The symbol and name must still work separately.

KEEP

- The exact name: MOtiVE 4 Artists
- A recognizable family link to MOtiVE Brooklyn through casing and rounded geometry
- Warm paper, charcoal ink, and controlled amber as continuity cues
- "the artist comes first." as an optional campaign line, not required inside the mark

AVOID

- Literal dancer silhouettes, hands, hearts, brushstroke swooshes, or nonprofit clip art
- A generic M4A acronym as the only identifying element
- Hairline detail that disappears at favicon or embroidery size
- AI sparkle artifacts, trend-first styling, or a mark that reads as studio rental



MOtiVE
ARTists

CURRENT MARK - USEFUL BASELINE

It preserves the sibling relationship and has a usable amber cue. The new round explores a clearer numeral, stronger small-size behavior, less vertical stacking, and a more ownable idea tied directly to artist-first support.

Artists First

MOtiVE **4**
ARTISTS

IDEA

The brand promise becomes the hierarchy: ARTISTS is the first thing the eye sees. MOtiVE and the custom four identify who is doing the supporting work.

optional: the artist comes first.

WHY IT IS STRONG

Immediate, plainspoken, and highly reproducible. It does not ask the board or the public to decode a metaphor. It is the strongest direction for mission clarity.

WATCHOUT

The numeral can become a symbol, but this territory is primarily a wordmark. A final cut needs custom letter spacing and rights-cleared or fully drawn letterforms.

4

MOtiVE **4**
ARTISTS

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ARTISTS

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ARTISTS

Open Room



IDEA

A program or room is built around the artist, but never closes around them. The four crosses the open edge: access, agency, and movement beyond the institution.

space and structure, kept open.

WHY IT IS STRONG

It has the clearest responsive system: full lockup, frame-and-four symbol, and numeral alone. Rounded geometry keeps a family resemblance without copying the current sail.

WATCHOUT

An architectural frame can drift toward real estate or construction if made too rigid. The final redraw should preserve the open, slightly human line quality.



Built Around the Artist



IDEA

Four open gestures gather around one amber point. They can stand for time, space, exchange, and counsel; the center remains the artist, not the organization.

support takes the shape the artist needs.

WHY IT IS STRONG

This is the most direct visual expression of tailored support. The human serif creates editorial warmth and clearly separates the nonprofit from a studio-rental identity.

WATCHOUT

Orbit and focus symbols are common. The arcs need a more proprietary hand-drawn rhythm in the next round so the mark does not resemble a loading indicator or camera reticle.



Moving Line



IDEA

One rehearsal-like line forms M and 4, then continues as a shifting ground beneath the name. The mark feels drawn, practiced, and still in motion rather than perfected.

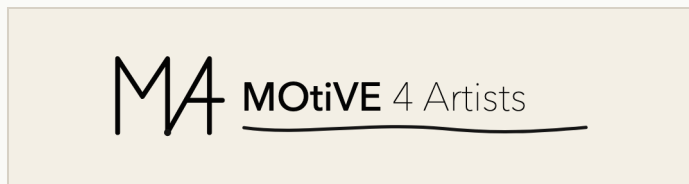
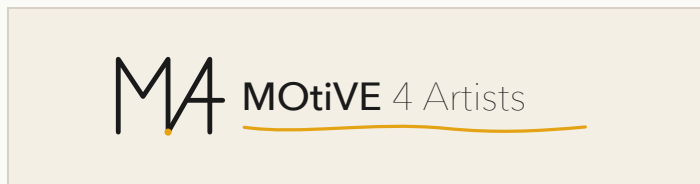
movement is a way of thinking

WHY IT IS STRONG

It connects directly to movement practice and the hand-painted studio origin. The monoline construction is inexpensive to print, cut, animate, and embroider.

WATCHOUT

M4 is a crowded commercial abbreviation. The monogram would require a careful visual and trademark search, and its custom gesture must carry more identity than the letters.



Working Seal



IDEA

A slightly irregular civic seal for a young organization doing serious work. Four amber notches hold the structure while the oversized four keeps it from becoming formal.

made in New York, built for artists.

WHY IT IS STRONG

Excellent on programs, certificates, tote bags, stamps, and partner materials. It gives funders an immediate signal of permanence and organizational confidence.

WATCHOUT

A seal can make the institution feel more important than the artist. It also needs a simplified core mark below 48px and should never imply a government endorsement.



EVALUATION

Score the idea, not the polish.

Initial working scores use a 1-5 scale. They are a discussion starter, not a substitute for artist feedback or legal clearance.

Criterion	01 Artists First	02 Open Room	03 Built Around	04 Moving Line	05 Working Seal
Distinctive in the category	4	4	3	3	3
Expresses artist-first support	5	5	5	4	3
Responsive / small-size system	3	5	5	4	3
Family continuity with MOtiVE	4	5	3	4	3
One-color reproduction	5	5	5	5	4
Funder-facing credibility	4	4	4	3	5
Working total / 30	25	28	25	23	21

RECOMMENDATION

Advance Open Room as the lead direction. Carry Artists First and Built Around the Artist into a second round so the board can compare clarity, symbol strength, and warmth after custom lettering and artist testing.

DO NOT DECIDE YET

Exact font, final spacing, shade of amber, tagline placement, or detailed production lockups. Those are refinements after the board chooses one or two concepts.

BOARD DISCUSSION

Choose a territory in 20 minutes.

Ask which direction best represents the organization artists should experience three years from now, not which image matches anyone's personal taste today.

01 / LOOK

SILENT FIRST PASS

Give everyone two minutes with the five marks. Each person notes the first concept they remember without reopening the packet.

02 / SCORE

USE SHARED CRITERIA

Independently score distinctiveness, artist-first fit, small-size use, family continuity, reproduction, and funder credibility.

03 / DISCUSS

NAME THE TRADE-OFF

For the top three, complete the sentence: "This direction gains ___, but risks ___." Avoid "I just like it" as the deciding argument.

04 / ADVANCE

SELECT TWO

Advance no more than two territories for custom vector refinement, artist interviews, real-world mockups, and preliminary visual clearance.

AFTER THE MEETING

Redraw the two finalists with custom letterforms; test at 16, 24, and 32px; apply them to the website header, social avatar, grant cover, tote, and one-color print; ask 5-8 artists what each mark communicates before revealing the rationale; then conduct federal and broader visual-mark clearance before launch.

Concept status: exploratory vector artwork. No concept has been trademark-cleared or production-outlined. Existing brand assets remain unchanged.